

Crops and their requirements

Crops are classified by their growing seasons and have specific temperature, water, and soil requirements.

Major Cropping Seasons in India

- **Kharif Crops:** Grown during the rainy monsoon season (June to September). They require hot weather and lots of water. Examples include rice, maize, and cotton. [1, 2]
 - **Rabi Crops:** Grown during the cool winter season (October to March). They need a warm climate for seed germination and a cold climate for growth. Examples include wheat, mustard, and green peas. [1, 2]
 - **Zaid Crops:** Grown in the short summer gap between Rabi and Kharif (March to June). Examples include watermelon, cucumber, and muskmelon. [1, 3]
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Requirements of Major Food and Cash Crops

- **Rice (Paddy):**
 - **Temperature:** High (above 25°C).
 - **Rainfall:** High rainfall or heavy irrigation (above 100 cm).
 - **Soil:** Clayey alluvial soil that holds water well. [4, 5, 6, 7]
- **Wheat:**
 - **Temperature:** Cool 10–15°C during sowing and 21–26°C with bright sun during ripening.
 - **Rainfall:** Moderate (75–100 cm).
 - **Soil:** Well-drained, fertile loamy or clayey-loam soil. [8]
- **Millets (Jowar, Bajra, Ragi):**
 - **Temperature:** High (27–32°C).
 - **Rainfall:** Low to moderate (50–100 cm); highly drought-resistant.
 - **Soil:** Inferior alluvial, sandy, or shallow black/red soils. [6, 8]
- **Maize:**
 - **Temperature:** Moderate (21–27°C).
 - **Rainfall:** Moderate (60–110 cm).
 - **Soil:** Old alluvial soil and fertile, well-drained soils. [5]
- **Pulses (Gram, Tur, Lentils):**
 - **Temperature:** Mild to warm.

- **Rainfall:** Low water requirement; dry conditions are tolerated well.
 - **Soil:** Sandy to clayey soils; they help restore nitrogen and soil fertility. [5, 9]
 - **Sugarcane:**
 - **Temperature:** High temperature (21–27°C).
 - **Rainfall:** High rainfall or heavy irrigation (75–150 cm).
 - **Soil:** Deep, rich, well-drained alluvial or loamy soils. [4]
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[1] <https://byjus.com>

[2] <https://www.youtube.com>

[3] <https://lotusarise.com>

[4] <https://www.instagram.com>

[5] <https://www.studocu.com>

[6] <https://www.youtube.com>

[7] <https://www.facebook.com>

[8] <https://www.drishtiias.com>

[9] <https://utkarshagro.com>

[10] <https://vajiramandravi.com>